

The Vikings

The Vikings lived more than 1,000 years ago. Their home was in Scandinavia, in northern Europe, but they are famous for their long sea journeys to distant lands.

Mast

The sail was made from wool or linen.

Longships

Viking boats were called longships. They were built from wood, and were fast and strong enough to cover vast distances.

Ropes

Viking travellers

The Vikings were daring sailors and explorers. They made fierce raids on the countries of western Europe. They went in search of trade and new lands to live in – even as far away as North America.



The Vikings reached North America in about the year 1000 CE.

A longship carried about 80 Vikings, who rowed and sailed the ship.